SALIG: Safe Spaces Awareness and Learning Initiative for Gender Protection

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An Gender Responsive Advocacy Proposal
presented to the
Gender and Development (GAD) Office of
Biliran Province State University
Naval, Biliran

In Partial Requirement
for the subject
Gender & Society
For the degree
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science –
School of Technology and Computer Studies

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GENDER-RESPONSIVE ENVIRONMENTAL SCAN

PART I

GENDER-RESPONSIVE ENVIRONMENTAL SCAN

A. INTRODUCTION

Overview of the Organization

Gender plays a crucial role in shaping equitable, safe, and inclusive environments across different sectors of society, including educational institutions such as the Biliran Province State University (BiPSU). In alignment with national policies on gender mainstreaming, the University has established its Gender and Development (GAD) Office to ensure that gender perspectives are integrated into all institutional programs, services, and operations.

The Gender and Development Office of Biliran Province State University is a designated unit under the direct supervision of the University President. It is composed of the GAD Director as Head of Office, the Heads of Gender Research and Support Services, the Head of GAD Training and Development, the GAD Secretariat, and additional support staff as needed. Working together with the Gender Focal Point System (GFPS), the GAD Office performs essential functions that promote gender equality and safeguard the rights and welfare of students, faculty, staff, and other stakeholders of the University.

Based on the GAD Manual, the GAD Office leads the integration of gender perspectives in university policies, plans, and programs. It ensures the assessment and evaluation of gender sensitivity and responsiveness within the institution and monitors the proper utilization of the GAD budget. The office also formulates recommendations for the effective implementation of GAD activities and strengthens partnerships with various agencies for gender responsive initiatives. In addition, it oversees the development of GAD Plans and Budgets, conducts gender trainings and seminars, facilitates gender related research,

assists in the generation of sex disaggregated data, and prepares GAD accomplishment reports.

The office also provides important services such as capacity building on gender sensitivity, development of information and education materials, coordination of gender related programs, and monitoring and evaluation of gender initiatives. Through these activities, the GAD Office functions as the main mechanism that ensures inclusivity, gender fairness, and the promotion of rights across the University community.

Gender responsiveness is highly important in this setting because the GAD Office serves as the key implementer of policies and programs that address gender gaps, uphold the protection and empowerment of all individuals, and support the University's goal of creating a safe, inclusive, and equitable learning environment.

B. METHODOLOGY

The activity was conducted using a descriptive quantitative approach in order to generate a comprehensive understanding of the Gender and Development (GAD) Office's programs, services, and existing gaps. The conduct of the activity took place in two major phases.

The first phase was carried out on April 12, 2026, through an initial face-to-face interview and an environmental scan at the GAD Office of Biliran Province State University. During this visit, the research team interviewed the GAD Director, Dr. Marianne B. Dagaylo-an, to gather information on the office's programs, services, functions, and ongoing challenges. Alongside the interview, an environmental scan was conducted to observe the physical office setup, gender-related signages, and visual indicators of gender mainstreaming within the workplace. These initial procedures enabled the team to identify existing gaps, areas for improvement, and potential topics for a gender-responsive advocacy proposal.

The second phase involved refining the selected topic based on the gaps identified during the initial interview and observation. In this phase, the team determined that the GAD Office did not yet have a program that assesses the knowledge and adherence of BiPSU students to Republic Act 11313, also known as the Safe Spaces Act or Bawal Bastos Law, particularly among students of the School of Technology and Computer Studies. After identifying this gap, the team conducted a Review of Related Literature to deepen the conceptual understanding of the identified gap or selected issue. A standardized research questionnaire was then adopted from the study of Dela Cruz et al. (2025) titled *"The Safe Spaces Act (R.A. 11313): Student Awareness and Adherence in a Private Higher Education Institution."* This tool was selected due to its validity, relevance, and alignment with the

identified advocacy focus. Data collection was conducted from April 21 to April 26, 2026, using an online Google Form distributed to the target respondents.

This combined use of interview, environmental scanning, document review, and survey methods allowed the researchers to gather triangulated data necessary for analyzing the gender responsiveness of the selected academic setting.

The School of Technology and Computer Studies (STCS) was selected as the locale of the study based on two primary considerations. First, the GAD Office recommended STCS as an appropriate setting due to the department's size, diversity of students, and relevance to current gender issues observed across various units of the University. Second, the researchers themselves are students of STCS, which allowed them to gain deeper insights into the gender-related practices, challenges, and awareness levels within their own academic community. The selection of STCS therefore ensured accessibility, familiarity, and alignment between the research objectives and the organizational context.

Official permission to conduct the study was obtained on April 20, 2026. A formal request letter was prepared and submitted to the Office of the Dean of the School of Technology and Computer Studies. The request was approved by Dr. Cheryl A. Ebajo, Dean of STCS, and was subsequently endorsed by the course instructor, Mr. Robert P. Logronio, as part of the academic requirements for the course Gender and Society. Only after receiving this written approval did the researchers proceed with the implementation of the study and the distribution of survey instruments.

The initial organizational visit, which included the face-to-face interview and environmental scan, was conducted on April 12, 2026 at the GAD Office of Biliran Province State University. This foundational visit provided the baseline information needed for developing the advocacy proposal and designing the data-gathering instruments.

Data Gathering Procedure

The data-gathering procedure consisted of four interrelated methods:

1. **Interview.** A initial interview was conducted with the GAD Director of Biliran Province State University, to collect in-depth information on the office's programs, responsibilities, challenges, and ongoing gender mainstreaming initiatives.
2. **Environmental Scan / Observation.** The research team conducted direct observations of the GAD Office to examine gender-related materials, facilities, and visual cues that reflect the institution's gender responsiveness.
3. **Review of Related Literature.** Relevant literature, policies, and previous studies were examined to support the analysis and strengthen the conceptual background of the selected advocacy topic.
4. **Survey Administration.** A standardized questionnaire adapted from Dela Cruz et al. (2025) was administered online from April 21 to April 26, 2026, via Google Forms. The survey captured quantitative data regarding student demographics and educational background, awareness, and adherence related to the identified topic or issue.

C. SUMMARY OF ENVIRONMENTAL SCAN

A. Physical / Visual Observations

During the environmental scan conducted at the Gender and Development (GAD) Office of Biliran Province State University on April 12, 2026, several physical and visual indicators of gender mainstreaming were observed. The GAD Office is situated in a visible and accessible area within the campus, providing a welcoming space for students, faculty, and staff seeking gender-related services or assistance. The office contains informational posters and printed materials related to gender sensitivity, anti-discrimination policies, and national gender laws, including the Safe Spaces Act (R.A. 11313). These materials were displayed on printed brochures, bulletin boards and walls, indicating the office's ongoing efforts to raise awareness on gender issues.

The office also had organized workstations for GAD personnel, shelves containing GAD Manuals and other reference materials, and a designated area for consultations and meetings. Despite the presence of informative materials, there were limited visual signages specifically promoting student awareness of their rights under R.A. 11313. Furthermore, no physical display explicitly communicated the University's grievance mechanisms or reporting procedures for gender-based sexual harassment cases. These observations provided initial insights into potential areas for enhancement, particularly in terms of visibility and accessibility of gender-related information.

B. Programmatic Observations (Interview Findings)

Based on the interview with the GAD Director, Dr. Marianne B. Dagaylo-an, the University's GAD Office currently implements multiple programs aligned with gender mainstreaming and the university's development framework. These include gender sensitivity

and awareness trainings, GAD lectures and seminars, capacity-building programs for faculty and staff, gender-focused research activities, and the preparation of GAD Plans and Budgets. The GAD Office also monitors GAD budget utilization, consolidates GAD accomplishment reports, and assists in generating sex-disaggregated data for institutional planning.

Furthermore, the office handles the preparation and submission of required GAD-related reports to national agencies, coordinates with external organizations for gender mainstreaming initiatives, and develops IEC materials for public awareness on gender issues. While these programs support the institution's compliance with national gender mandates, the interview revealed that the office currently has no specific initiative aimed at evaluating students' knowledge, awareness, and adherence to R.A. 11313, especially at the level of individual academic departments such as the School of Technology and Computer Studies. This gap became a significant point of reflection during the environmental scan and interview process.

D. GAP IDENTIFICATION

Based on the combined findings from the environmental scan and the interview, the primary gap identified is the absence of a structured assessment program that evaluates students' knowledge and adherence to R.A. 11313 or the Safe Spaces Act, particularly among students of the School of Technology and Computer Studies (STCS). Although the GAD Office provides gender-related trainings and prepares IEC materials, there is no dedicated mechanism or program that measures students' understanding of the law, their level of awareness of prohibited acts, and their familiarity with reporting procedures and support services available to them.

This gap is a concern for several reasons. First, R.A. 11313 mandates all educational institutions to ensure that students are informed about forms of gender-based sexual harassment, including online harassment, and that they know how to report incidents. Without a systematic assessment, the University may be unaware of potential knowledge deficiencies that limit students' ability to recognize or respond to harassment. Second, the absence of monitoring mechanisms may hinder the GAD Office's capacity to design targeted interventions or trainings that address specific areas of low awareness.

The environmental scan supports this gap by showing that while general gender-related posters were visible, there were few materials specifically focused on the Safe Spaces Act or student reporting procedures. Moreover, the interview with the GAD Director confirmed that no existing program has yet been developed to assess awareness and adherence to the Safe Spaces Act among STCS students. This lack of assessment affects all students within the department, particularly those who may be vulnerable to gender-based harassment but lack sufficient knowledge about their rights and protections under the law.

This identified gap thus underscores the need for a structured advocacy project aimed at increasing awareness, enhancing adherence, and strengthening the University's compliance with national mandates on safe and gender-responsive educational environments.

E. SUMMARY OF FINDINGS

The study titled “Knowledge and Adherence to R.A. 11313 – Safe Spaces Act Among Students of the School of Technology and Computer Studies at Biliran Province State University” gathered responses from 303 students and examined their demographic and educational characteristics, level of knowledge of the Safe Spaces Act, and their adherence to its provisions. The demographic profile revealed that the majority of respondents were male, representing 60.4 percent of the total 303 participants, while females made up 39.6 percent. Most respondents belonged to the 18–22-year-old age group, accounting for 97.1 percent, indicating that the participants were predominantly young adults. In terms of class status, 95 percent of the students were regular students, while only 5 percent were irregular. Regarding college programs, the largest proportion of respondents came from the BS in Industrial Technology program, representing 43.6 percent, followed by BS in Information Systems at 34.7 percent, and BS in Computer Science at 21.8 percent. The distribution of year levels showed that first-year and second-year students constituted almost the entire sample, representing 48.5 percent and 47.9 percent respectively, while third-year and fourth-year students accounted for only 3.3 percent and 0.3 percent.

Findings on the level of knowledge of the Safe Spaces Act (R.A. 11313) showed generally positive awareness across physical spaces, social spaces, and institutional implementation. In terms of physical spaces, the students agreed that BiPSU-STCS ensures safety and confidentiality, with indicators on policy implementation and proper document management receiving the highest means of 2.97. The lowest mean, 2.83, still interpreted as “Agree,” highlighted that classrooms are perceived to be secure and free from physical hazards. The overall weighted mean of 2.92 indicated that students recognize the institution’s efforts toward maintaining a safe physical environment.

Regarding social spaces, respondents again showed agreement across all indicators, with a total weighted mean of 2.98. The highest-rated indicator was the encouragement of positive student interactions by teachers and staff, with a mean of 3.07. Students also agreed that they feel welcomed, respected, and able to seek help from peers. Meanwhile, expressions of beliefs and identities, psychological safety policies, and access to peer support had slightly lower, yet still positive, means ranging from 2.93 to 2.96. Overall, the findings suggest that STCS fosters a respectful and inclusive social atmosphere.

In terms of institutional implementation, students agreed that the Safe Spaces Act is actively integrated into university systems and programs, resulting in a total weighted mean of 2.99. The highest mean of 3.05 was given to the Guidance Office's provision of counseling and support services for concerns related to the Safe Spaces Act. Classroom discussions about the law also received high agreement, with a mean of 2.99. While the integration of SSA in orientations, handbooks, and promotional platforms received slightly lower agreement, means ranged from 2.96 to 2.98, showing that institutional implementation is present but may require further strengthening.

The study also assessed students' level of adherence to the Safe Spaces Act in terms of personal practices. The results indicated strong adherence, with a total weighted mean of 3.11 interpreted as "Agree." The highest mean, 3.22, reflected students' respect for personal boundaries and avoidance of intrusive or inappropriate behaviors. High adherence was also observed in the students' avoidance of cyberbullying, unwanted invitations, sexual harassment, and inappropriate jokes, with means exceeding 3.16. Meanwhile, the lowest adherence scores were in speaking up against peers' inappropriate actions (3.00) and reporting harassment (3.01), suggesting that although students avoid committing violations themselves, they may be less confident in confronting or reporting misconduct.

Overall, the findings reveal that students from the School of Technology and Computer Studies have a generally positive understanding of the Safe Spaces Act and demonstrate strong adherence to its principles. The institution has successfully established a safe learning environment across physical, social, and institutional dimensions. However, the areas of bystander intervention and reporting mechanisms show relatively lower levels of agreement, indicating opportunities for the development of targeted awareness programs, strengthened reporting systems, and advocacy efforts to enhance student engagement in upholding the Safe Spaces Act.

F. PRESENTATION OF DATA

This section presents the overall results and discussion of the study. All the data obtained were tallied, analyzed, and interpreted by the researchers.

PART I. DEMOGRAPHICS AND EDUCATION

1. Demographic Profile of the Respondents in Terms of Sex

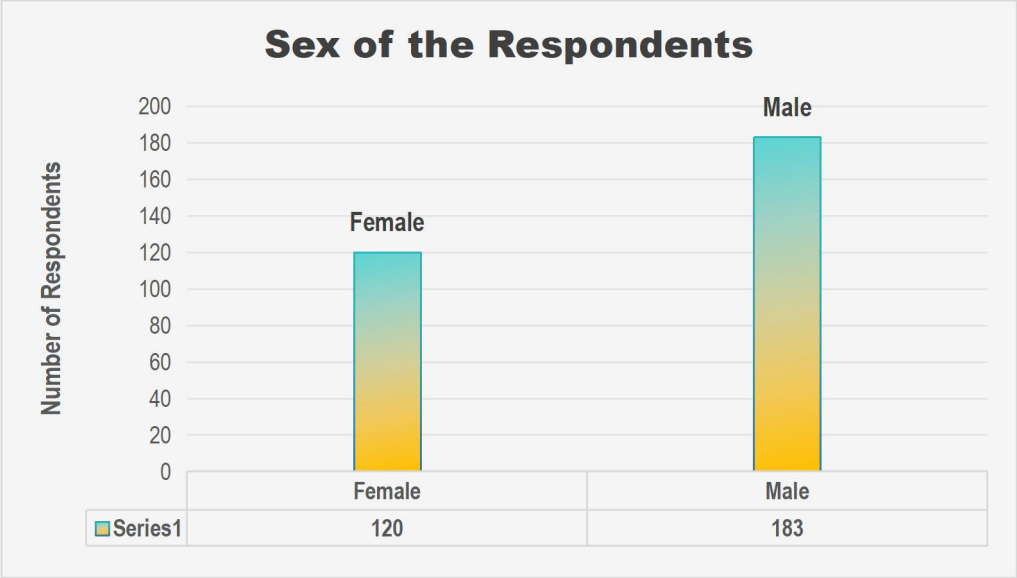


***Figure 1*. Sex of Respondents**

Figure 1 shows that the majority of the respondents were male. Out of 303 total respondents, 183 were male, making up about 60.4% of the total. Meanwhile, there were 120 female respondents, representing only 39.6%. This indicates that most of the respondents in this study were male..

2. Demographic Profile of the Respondents in Terms of Age

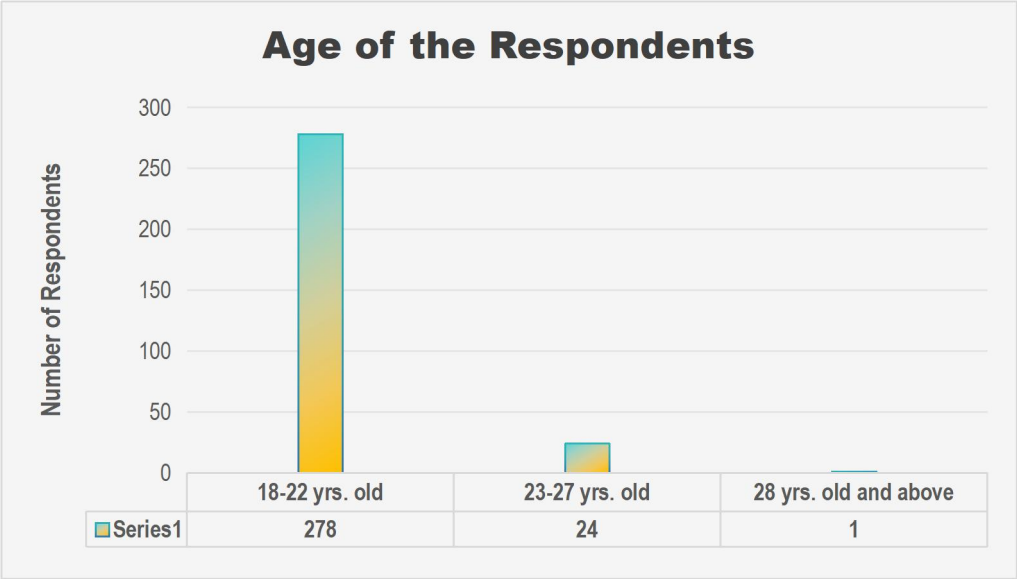


***Figure 2*. Age of the Respondents**

"Figure 2 shows that the majority of the respondents belong to the 18–22-year-old age group, with 278 respondents making up 97.1% of the total. This indicates that most of the students who participated in the survey are young adults. Meanwhile, 24 respondents, or 7.9%, belong to the 23–27-year-old age group. Additionally, 1 respondent, or 0.4%, falls within the 28 years old and above age group. Overall, the data show that the students of the School of Technology and Computer Studies are mostly young individuals.

3. Educational Background of the Respondents in Terms of Class Status

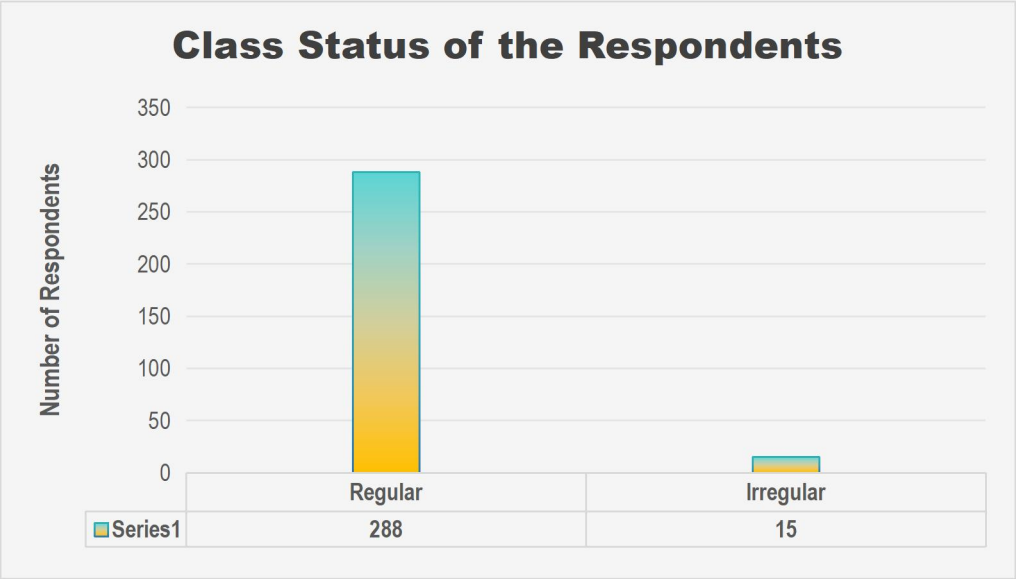


***Figure 3*. Class Status of the Respondents**

Figure 3 shows that the majority of the respondents were regular students, with 288 respondents making up 95% of the total, while only 5% or 15 respondents were irregular students. This indicates that most of the students in the School of Technology and Computer Studies are progressing through their studies in the usual and expected manner.

4. Educational Background of the Respondents in Terms of College Program

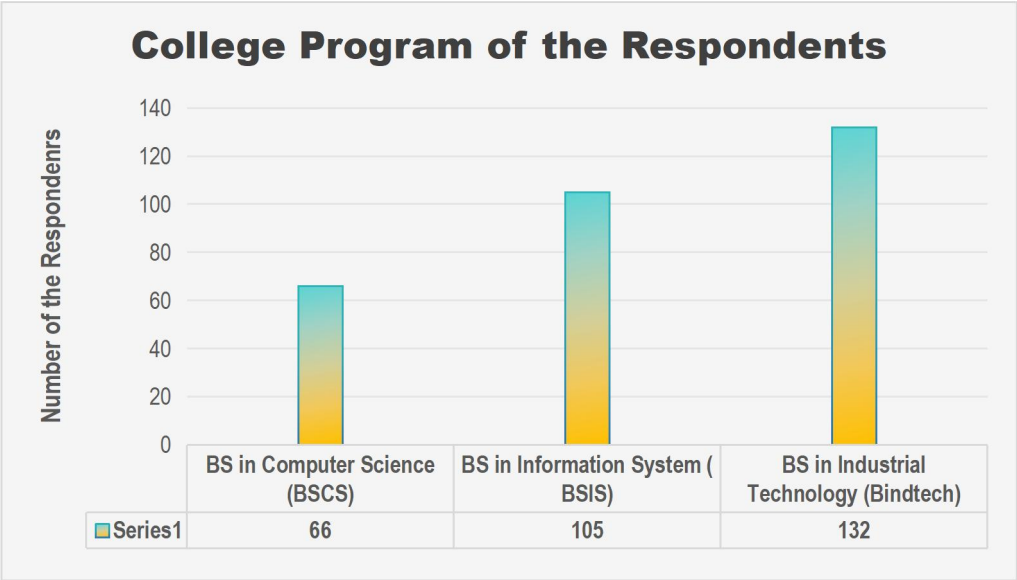


***Figure 4*. College Program of the Respondents**

Figure 4 shows that the largest percentage of respondents came from the BS in Industrial Technology (BIndTech) program, with 132 respondents, making up 43.6% of the total. This means that almost half of the students who participated in the survey are BIndTech students. The next largest group was from the BS in Information Systems (BSIS) program, with 105 respondents or 34.7%. Meanwhile, the BS in Computer Science (BSCS) program had the lowest number of respondents, with 66 students or 21.8% of the total.

5. Educational Background of the Respondents in Terms of Year Level

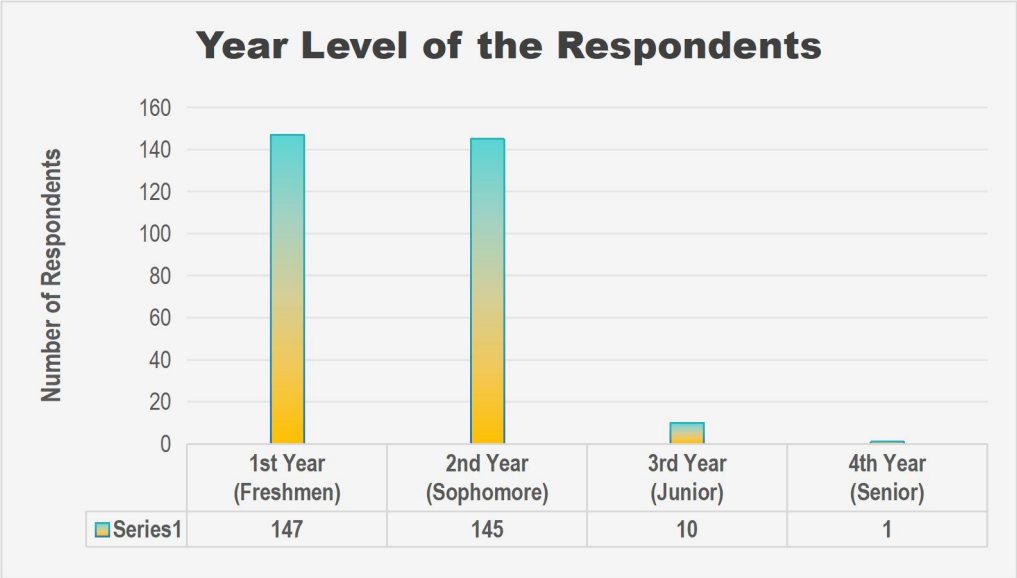


***Table 5*. Year Level of the Respondents**

Figure 5 shows that the majority of the respondents came from the lower year levels. First-year students had the largest percentage, with 147 respondents or 48.5%, followed by second-year students with 145 respondents or 47.9%. Together, these two year levels made up almost the entire sample at nearly 96% of the total. On the other hand, third-year students accounted for only 10 respondents or 3.3%, while fourth-year students had the least number of respondents, with only 1 or 0.3%, indicating that only one student from this year level participated in the survey.

PART II. LEVEL OF KNOWLEDGE TO THE SAFE SPACES ACT (R.A. 11313) IN TERMS OF: PHYSICAL SPACES, SOCIAL SPACES, AND INSTITUTIONS IMPLEMENTATION

1. Respondents Level of Knowledge of Safe Spaces Act (RA 11313) in terms of Physical Spaces

No.	Criteria	Mean	Interpretation
1	The classroom is secure and free from physical hazards.	**2.83**	**Agree**
2	The policies on maintaining the physical safety within and outside the classroom for all students are implemented.	**2.91**	**Agree**
3	The management and storage of documents are practiced properly with confidentiality by teachers and staff.	**2.97**	**Agree**
4	The teachers and staff participate on tasks in security and monitoring that ensures the safety and security of students during and outside class hours.	**2.97**	**Agree**
5	The students are aware of the different support services that help in ensuring their safety and needs.	**2.96**	**Agree**
Total Weighted Mean		**2.92**	**Agree**

Table 1. **Respondents Level of Knowledge of Safe Spaces Act (RA 11313) in terms of Physical Spaces**

Table 1 shows that in terms of Physical Spaces, the respondents' level of knowledge of the Safe Spaces Act (RA 11313) is generally high. Item No. 2, 'The policies on maintaining physical safety within and outside the classroom for all students are implemented,' and Item No. 3, 'The management and storage of documents are practiced properly with confidentiality by teachers and staff,' both have the highest mean of 2.97 with an interpretation of 'Agree.' This indicates that students recognize the efforts of teachers and staff in maintaining confidentiality and ensuring student safety. Meanwhile, Item No. 1, 'The classroom is secure and free from physical hazards,' has the lowest mean of 2.83, also interpreted as 'Agree,' showing that students still generally perceive their classrooms as safe.

Overall, the total weighted mean of 2.92, interpreted as 'Agree,' indicates that the school is effectively providing a safe and secure physical environment for students.

2. **Respondents Level of Knowledge of Safe Spaces Act (RA 11313) in terms of Social Spaces**

No.	Criteria	Mean	Interpretation
1	The students are allowed to express their beliefs and identities without judgement.	**2.93**	**Agree**
2	The students can actively seek help and ask for peer support in class.	**2.96**	**Agree**
3	The institution maintains a positive vibe in making the students feel welcomed and respected.	**3.02**	**Agree**
4	The institution implements policies on maintaining psychological safety within the school. (e.g. zero tolerance of harassment/bullying).	**2.93**	**Agree**
5	The teachers and staff encourage students to interact with one another in positive ways.	**3.07**	**Agree**
Total Weighted Mean		**2.98**	**Agree**

Table 2. **Respondents Level of Knowledge of Safe Spaces Act (RA 11313) in terms of Social Spaces**

Table 2 presents the respondents' level of knowledge of the Safe Spaces Act (RA 11313) in terms of Social Spaces. Among the five indicators, Item No. 5, 'The teachers and staff encourage students to interact with one another in positive ways,' has the highest mean of 3.07 with an interpretation of 'Agree.' This indicates that students recognize the efforts of teachers and staff in promoting good relationships and positive communication within the STCS department.The next highest mean is Item No. 3, 'The institution maintains a positive vibe in making the students feel welcomed and respected,' with a mean of 3.02 and an interpretation of 'Agree,' showing that students generally feel accepted and valued within the school. Meanwhile, Item No. 1, 'The students are allowed to express their beliefs and identities without judgment,' Item No. 4, 'The institution implements policies on maintaining psychological safety within the school (e.g., zero tolerance for harassment or bullying),' and

Item No. 2, 'The students can actively seek help and ask for peer support in class,' received lower mean scores of 2.93 and 2.96, but both are still interpreted as 'Agree.' This indicates that students feel comfortable seeking support, expressing themselves, and are aware of the school's efforts to maintain a safe environment. Overall, this section has a total weighted mean of 2.98, interpreted as 'Agree,' showing that students believe the school succeeds in creating a safe, friendly, and supportive social environment where everyone feels comfortable and respected

3. **Respondents Level of Knowledge of Safe Spaces Act (RA 11313) in terms of Institutional Implementation**

No.	Criteria	Mean	Interpretation
1	The institution has integrated the Safe Spaces Act during orientation programs to educate students about their rights and responsibilities under this law.	**2.96**	**Agree**
2	The institution has included information about the Safe Spaces Act in its student manual or handbook, ensuring that all students have access to clear guidelines and policies.	**2.98**	**Agree**
3	The institution actively promotes the Safe Spaces Act through posters, announcements, or online platforms to ensure widespread awareness within the campus community.	**2.98**	**Agree**
4	The academic departments include topics related to the Safe Spaces Act and its importance in relevant subjects or classroom discussions.	**2.99**	**Agree**
5	The Guidance Office provides counseling and support services for students who experience or witness violations of the Safe Spaces Act.	**3.05**	**Agree**
Total Weighted Mean		**2.99**	**Agree**

Table 3. **Respondents Level of Knowledge of Safe Spaces Act (RA 11313) in terms of Institutions Implementation of R.A. 11313**

Table 3 shows that in terms of Physical Spaces under the respondents' level of knowledge of the Safe Spaces Act (RA 11313), Item No. 5, 'The Guidance Office provides counseling and support services for students who experience or witness violations of the Safe

Spaces Act,' received the highest mean of 3.05 with an interpretation of 'Agree.' This indicates that students recognize the efforts of the Guidance Office in offering support and assistance related to concerns involving the Safe Spaces Act. The next highest indicator is Item No. 4, which has a mean of 2.99 and an interpretation of 'Agree,' showing that students acknowledge that their teachers discuss and include the Safe Spaces Act in their class lessons. Meanwhile, Items No. 2 and No. 3 both have a mean of 2.98, and Item No. 1 has the lowest mean of 2.96; all are interpreted as 'Agree.' This indicates that students are aware that the institution provides information and promotes the Safe Spaces Act through various platforms and materials, and that they recognize the institution's efforts in discussing the Act during orientation programs. Overall, the total weighted mean of this section is 2.99, interpreted as 'Agree,' which shows that the institution is actively implementing the Safe Spaces Act through orientation programs, policies, awareness campaigns, classroom discussions, and support services within the campus.

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PART III. LEVEL OF ADHERENCE TO THE SAFE SPACES ACT (R.A. 11313)

1. **Respondents Level of Adherence to the Safe Spaces Act (RA 11313)**

No.	Criteria	Mean	Interpretation
1	I actively avoid catcalling or making unsolicited comments about someone's appearance.	**3.08**	**Agree**
2	I refrain from making misogynistic, transphobic, homophobic, or sexist slurs in any setting.	**3.01**	**Agree**
3	I do not make or share sexual jokes or content that could make others uncomfortable.	**3.17**	**Agree**
4	I ensure that my online behavior does not include cyberbullying, cyberstalking, or gender-based online sexual harassment.	**3.21**	**Agree**
5	I avoid behaviors like wolf-whistling, making unwanted invitations, or engaging in groping or sexual assault.	**3.19**	**Agree**
6	I consciously avoid making offensive body gestures or engaging in actions that could be considered sexually inappropriate.	**3.16**	**Agree**

7	I respect personal boundaries and avoid cursing, taunting, or using intrusive gazing toward others.	**3.22**	**Agree**
8	I report incidents of gender-based harassment or discrimination to the appropriate authorities if I witness or experience them.	**3.01**	**Agree**
9	I actively call out or discourage peers from making derogatory remarks or engaging in inappropriate actions against others.	**3.0**	**Agree**
10	I believe that my school is fostering a safe and inclusive environment and is shared responsibility among all students.	**3.12**	**Agree**
Total Weighted Mean		**3.11**	**Agree**

Table 4. **Respondents Level of Adherence to the Safe Spaces Act (RA 11313) in terms of Practices**

Table 8 shows the Level of Adherence to the Safe Spaces Act in terms of its Practices. The table presents that among the indicators, No. 7 "I respect personal boundaries and avoid cursing, taunting, or using intrusive gazing toward others." has the highest mean with 3.22 interpreted as "Agree", this indicates that most students of STCS are aware of the importance of respecting other people's personal space and behavior. The No. 4 and No. 5 with 3.21 and 3.19 mean respectively, both interpreted as "Agree", showing that students are also careful and responsible in their actions both online and in person. On the other hand, No. 9 got the lowest mean of 3.0, followed by No. 2 and No. 8 both with a mean of 3.01, all interpreted as "Agree", this shows that while students still agree on these behaviors, there is a slightly lower level of confidence or action when it comes to speaking up or reporting incidents. Overall, this section has a total weighted mean of 3.11 interpreted as "Agree", showing that the students generally practice good and respectful behavior towards others and are aware of their responsibilities in helping maintain a safe and inclusive environment in the school.

GENDER-RESPONSIVE ADVOCACY PROPOSAL

PART II

ADVOCACY PROPOSAL

A. Title of the Proposal

SALIG: Safe Spaces Awareness and Learning Initiative for Gender Protection

A Gender-Responsive Advocacy and Capacity-Building Program on Strengthening Student Understanding and Compliance with R.A. 11313 for STCS Students

B. Rationale

Based on the results of the study "Knowledge and Adherence to R.A. 11313 – Safe Spaces Act Among Students of the School of Technology and Computer Studies," several important gaps were identified concerning students' awareness and adherence to the Safe Spaces Act. Although respondents demonstrated generally positive knowledge and strong adherence to respectful behaviors, certain areas still require focused intervention. Specifically, findings revealed lower levels of awareness regarding institutional reporting mechanisms, bystander intervention, and understanding of prohibited acts under the Safe Spaces Act.

The environmental scan also indicated that while the GAD Office provides general gender-related information materials, there remains a lack of visible signages, student-centered advocacy activities, and department-based assessment programs focused specifically on R.A. 11313. During the interview with the GAD Director, it was confirmed that no structured program currently exists within the GAD Office that assesses or strengthens STCS students' knowledge and compliance related to the Safe Spaces Act. This gap poses a concern because students who are unaware of their rights, responsibilities, or reporting procedures may hesitate to report harassment, fail to recognize violations, or remain passive bystanders during unsafe situations.

Given these observations, the Gender-Responsive Advocacy Proposal titled SALIG aims to enhance STCS students' understanding and adherence to the Safe Spaces Act through targeted interventions such as orientation caravans, awareness campaigns, IEC material development, bystander intervention training, and familiarization with school-based reporting procedures. The program seeks to equip students with the confidence to identify violations, speak up against harassment, and utilize institutional support systems. By addressing gaps in knowledge, reporting awareness, and bystander engagement, this proposal aims to foster a safer, more empowered, and gender-responsive academic environment within the School of Technology and Computer Studies.

C. Objectives

This advocacy proposal aims to address the identified gaps through strategic and gender-responsive interventions. Specifically, it seeks to:

1. Increase STCS students' awareness and understanding of the Safe Spaces Act, including prohibited acts, rights, responsibilities, and campus-based reporting mechanisms.
2. Enhance students' ability to identify, respond to, and report gender-based harassment or violations of the Safe Spaces Act.
3. Strengthen bystander awareness and intervention skills among STCS students through structured, scenario-based training.
4. Provide accessible and student-friendly IEC materials on the Safe Spaces Act in both digital and physical formats to ensure widespread dissemination.
5. Support the GAD Office in establishing a sustainable, department-level awareness and capacity-building program on R.A. 11313 for continuous implementation.

D. Description of the Proposed Intervention

The proposed advocacy, **SALIG**, is designed as a multi-component awareness and capacity-building program centered on strengthening student knowledge and adherence to the Safe Spaces Act. It integrates information dissemination, interactive learning, skills training, and institutional support to ensure holistic learning and sustained behavioral reinforcement. The intervention includes the following components:

1. Safe Spaces Ambassador Certification Program

This component trains selected STCS students to become Safe Spaces Ambassadors equipped with foundational knowledge of R.A. 11313, bystander intervention strategies, and proper campus reporting procedures. These ambassadors serve as peer advocates who help promote respectful behavior, support their classmates, and assist in disseminating Safe Spaces Act information within their departments.

2. Gender Guard Challenge Week

A week-long gamified learning campaign that engages students through quizzes, campus missions, digital tasks, and scenario-based challenges focused on identifying prohibited acts, responding safely to harassment, and strengthening their understanding of Safe Spaces principles. The activity fosters friendly competition while reinforcing correct knowledge and behaviors.

3. **"Tap & Tell" QR Code Information Trail and Digital Diary of Safe Spaces**

This component introduces an interactive campus information trail where QR codes are placed in strategic student areas, directing learners to concise IEC materials on rights, responsibilities, and reporting channels under the Safe Spaces Act. Paired with this is the Digital Diary of Safe Spaces, an anonymous online "confession box" where students can privately share experiences, concerns, or observations—providing the GAD Office with valuable insights that can guide future interventions.

4. **Kwento ng Ligtas na Espasyo: Film & Reel Festival**

A creative advocacy activity where students produce short films and reels depicting Safe Spaces Act scenarios, responsible bystander actions, and stories that promote respect and empowerment. This festival transforms legal concepts into relatable narratives and allows students to express their perspectives while raising awareness among their peers.

5. **Online Learning Module on R.A. 11313**

An accessible, interactive online module featuring video lessons, short readings, and a post-test designed to reinforce student learning about the Safe Spaces Act. The module ensures consistent delivery of accurate information and allows the GAD Office to assess improvements in student awareness and comprehension.

E. Target Beneficiaries

The primary beneficiaries of the **SALIG** advocacy program are:

1. **All STCS students.** These students directly benefit from the Safe Spaces Ambassador Certification Program, the Gender Guard Challenge Week, the Tap & Tell QR Code Information Trail, the Digital Diary of Safe Spaces, the Kwento ng Ligtas na Espasyo Film and Reel Festival, and the Online Learning Module. As one of the largest student population in Biliran Province State University these activities provide them with essential knowledge on the Safe Spaces Act, improved bystander intervention skills, and accessible platforms for learning, reporting, and expression.
2. **STCS faculty and staff.** Faculty and staff serve as role models and primary implementers of gender-responsive practices. Through exposure to the QR Code Information Trail, insights gained from student submissions in the Digital Diary of Safe Spaces, and the advocacy messages highlighted in the Film and Reel Festival, they develop stronger awareness and sensitivity to Safe Spaces concerns. This enhances their

capacity to support and uphold Safe Spaces policies within classrooms and campus spaces.

3. **The GAD Office of BiPSU.** The GAD Office benefits from strengthened support for its gender mainstreaming initiatives. Activities such as the Safe Spaces Ambassador Program, the QR-linked IEC materials, the Digital Diary, and the Online Learning Module provide useful advocacy tools, opportunities for student engagement, and relevant data that help improve monitoring, reporting, and continuous implementation of R.A. 11313 across the department.
4. **Student organizations and class leaders.** Student leaders play an important role in promoting and extending the reach of the advocacy. Through their participation in the Challenge Week, involvement in the Film and Reel Festival, and collaboration with Safe Spaces Ambassadors, they gain increased capacity to mobilize peers, model respectful behavior, and disseminate accurate Safe Spaces Act information within their respective groups.

F. Implementation Plan

Component / Activity	Persons Involved	Time Frame	Resources Needed	Expected Output
1. Safe Spaces Ambassador Certification Progra	• GAD Office • STCS Dean • Trained GAD Resource	2 days training; annual implementation	• Training kits • Certificates • Projector • Modules • Venue	• Certified Safe Spaces Ambassadors capable of peer

m	Persons • Selected Student Ambassadors			education and advocacy support
2. Gender Guard Challenge Week	• GAD Office • STCS Student Council • Faculty Coordinators	1 week per semester	• Printed and digital challenge cards • Prizes • Posters • QR tasks • Computers/mobile devices	• Increased student engagement and improved understanding of Safe Spaces concepts through gamified learning
3. "Tap & Tell" QR Code Informa	• GAD Office • IT Departme	2 weeks preparation; year-round use	• QR stickers • Printing services • Design software • IEC content	• Easily accessible Safe Spaces informati

tion Trail and Digital Diary of Safe Spaces	nt • Student Creative Team			on across STCS buildings
4. Kwentong Ligtas na Espasyo: Film and Reel Festival	• GAD Office • STCS Student Organizations • Faculty Judges	1 month preparation; annual festival	• Cameras/phones • Editing software • Venue, screen/projector • Certificates • Prizes	• Student-produced films and reels that promote Safe Spaces awarenes.
5. Online Learning Module on R.A. 11313	• STCS IT Department • GAD Office	1 month development; per semester rollout	• LMS access • Video recordings • Editing tools	• Increased Safe Spaces Act knowledge through e-learning.

G. Expected Outcomes

By the end of the SALIG Advocacy Program, the following outcomes are anticipated:

1. At least 80% of STCS students will demonstrate increased knowledge of R.A. 11313 based on pre-test and post-test assessments.
2. Students will exhibit improved understanding of campus reporting mechanisms, reflected in surveys, help desk consultations, and digital diary submissions.
3. Increased student confidence and preparedness to intervene safely in harassment-related situations.
4. Visible and sustained presence of Safe Spaces Act promotional and educational materials across STCS buildings and online platforms.
5. Fully functional online learning module and information trail supporting continuous Safe Spaces awareness.
6. Strengthened collaboration between the GAD Office, STCS faculty, and student leaders in implementing gender-responsive programs.

H. Budget Estimate (Optional)

Item	Quantity	Unit Cost	Total Cost
Supplies and Materials			
Posters and IEC Printing for QR Trail, Challenge Week, and Ambassador Program	80 pcs.	50	4,000
QR Stickers (Tap & Tell Trail)	60 pcs.	15	900
Certificates for Ambassadors and Film Festival	50 pcs.	15	750
Training Kits (folders, pens, paper)	20 set	100	2,000

Meals and Snacks			
Snacks & Food for Ambassador Certification Program	40 pax	300	12,000
Snacks & Food for Gender Guard Challenge Week Activities	20 pax	300	9,000
Snacks for Film & Reel Festival Participants / Judges	20 pax	300	9,000
Lunch for Speaker and Facilitators	4 pax	500	2.000
Facilitator Honorarium			
Resource Speakers for Ambassador Training	4 persons	5,000	20,000
Judges for Film & Reel Festival	3 persons	2,000	6,000
Digital and Technical Materials			
LMS Module Development Materials (editing tools, software licenses as needed)	-	-	2, 000
Prizes for Gender Guard Challenge Week	10 winners	1,000	10, 000
Prizes for Film & Reel Festival	5 winners	500	2,500
Miscellaneous / Contingencies	**-**	**-**	5,000
OVERALL TOTAL:			**Php 85,150**

I. Monitoring and Evaluation

Monitoring and evaluation will be conducted to ensure the SALIG Advocacy Program achieves its objectives and continuously responds to student needs. The following mechanisms will be implemented:

- **Post-Training and Post-Event Evaluation Forms** to measure student comprehension, satisfaction, and engagement across activities such as the Ambassador Certification Program, Challenge Week, and Film Festival.
- **Pre-test and Post-test Assessments** for the Online Learning Module and Ambassador Training to assess knowledge improvement on R.A. 11313.
- **Digital Diary Logs** documenting recurring student concerns, insights, and reports submitted anonymously through the online platform.
- **QR Code Analytics** from the Tap & Tell Information Trail to track student access frequency, viewed materials, and peak engagement times.
- **Activity Monitoring Checklists** to ensure QR codes, posters, and IEC materials remain visible, updated, and properly maintained across campus.
- **Film Festival Review Sheets** to evaluate the thematic accuracy, impact, and clarity of student-created advocacy films and reels.
- **Student Feedback Surveys** to gather perceptions of campus safety, awareness of reporting mechanisms, and readiness to intervene during unsafe situations.
- **Monthly Coordination Meetings** between the GAD Office, STCS leadership, and Safe Spaces Ambassadors to review accomplishments, address challenges, and refine strategies.
- **Quarterly GAD Progress Reports** compiling program outputs, observations, student trends from the Digital Diary, and recommendations for sustainability.

CONCLUSION

The SALIG: Safe Spaces Awareness and Learning Initiative for Gender Protection was developed as a direct and strategic response to the gaps identified in students' knowledge, reporting awareness, and practical understanding of the Safe Spaces Act (R.A. 11313) within the School of Technology and Computer Studies. Although the initial findings revealed that students generally demonstrate positive attitudes and foundational knowledge of respectful behavior, they also highlighted areas that require immediate and targeted intervention, particularly in recognizing prohibited acts, understanding campus-based reporting protocols, and confidently engaging in bystander intervention.

Through its multifaceted components, the SALIG advocacy program offers a comprehensive, student-centered, and gender-responsive approach to addressing these gaps. Initiatives such as the Safe Spaces Ambassador Certification Program, the Gender Guard Challenge Week, the Tap & Tell QR Code Information Trail, the Digital Diary of Safe Spaces, the Kwento ng Ligtas na Espasyo Film and Reel Festival, and the Online Learning Module collectively aim to strengthen students' awareness, engagement, and overall competence in applying the principles of the Safe Spaces Act in real-life contexts. These interventions ensure that learning is not only accessible but also interactive, creative, and relevant to the lived experiences of STCS students.

Moreover, the program promotes collaborative involvement among student leaders, faculty, the GAD Office, and the academic community. This shared responsibility fosters a culture of vigilance, respect, safety, and empowerment across the department. Through continuous monitoring, evaluation, and refinement, SALIG supports the long-term goal of institutionalizing Safe Spaces awareness and ensuring that gender responsiveness remains an integral part of STCS' academic and social environment.

Overall, the SALIG advocacy initiative underscores the commitment of the School of Technology and Computer Studies to building an educational environment where every learner is informed of their rights, confident in exercising them, and empowered to contribute to a safe and inclusive community. By equipping students with knowledge, platforms for expression, and opportunities for active participation, SALIG sets the foundation for a campus culture that upholds dignity, equality, and protection for all.

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APPENDICES

Appendix A

Letter of Request

Appendix B

Approved Permission

Appendix C

Interview Notes or Transcript

Appendix D

Questionnaire or Survey Tool

Republic of the Philippines
BILIRAN PROVINCE STATE UNIVERSITY
ISO 9001:2015 CERTIFIED
SCHOOL OF TECHNOLOGY AND COMPUTER STUDIES

SURVEY INSTRUMENT

Dear Respondent,

The undersigned are conducting a study entitled **KNOWLEDGE AND ADHERENCE TO R.A. 11313 – SAFE SPACES ACT AMONG STUDENTS OF THE SCHOOL OF TECHNOLOGY AND COMPUTER STUDIES AT BILIRAN PROVINCE STATE UNIVERSITY"** as part of the requirements for the subject *Gender and Society* and in partial fulfillment of the degree **Bachelor of Science in Computer Science (BSCS).**

We respectfully request your participation by answering the questions provided below. Rest assured that all data collected through this survey will be used solely for academic purposes and will be treated with the utmost confidentiality.

Respectfully yours,

Arian Jay G. Maala & **Sarah Jane E. Villanueva**
Researchers

PART I. DEMOGRAPHICS AND EDUCATION

Name *(Optional)*: _____ Sex: ☐ Male ☐ Female

Age: ☐ 18-22 yrs. old
☐ 23-27 yrs. old
☐ 28 yrs. old and above

Class Status: ☐ Regular ☐ Irregular

Program: ☐ BS in Computer Science (BSCS)
☐ BS in Information System (BSIS)
☐ BS in Industrial Technology (BindTech)
Specialization/Major *(If BindTech)*: _____

Year Level: ☐ 1st Year

☐ 2nd Year

☐ 3rd Year

☐ 4th Year

Section: _____

PART II. LEVEL OF KNOWLEDGE TO THE SAFE SPACES ACT (R.A. 11313) IN TERMS OF: PHYSICAL SPACES, SOCIAL SPACES, AND INSTITUTIONS IMPLEMENTATION

Direction: Please indicate the extent of your agreement as a BiPSU student regarding ***"R.A. 11313 – SAFE SPACES ACT"*** in terms of your **Level of Knowledge** of the law across **Physical Spaces, Social Spaces,** and its **Institutional Implementation** within the school and university.

Please put a check on the appropriate answer using the following scale:

4 – Strongly Agree **3** – Agree **2** – *Disagree* **1** – Strongly Disagree

Level of Knowledge to the Safe Spaces Act (R.A. 11313) *(Borito & Yango, 2022; Cruz et al., 2025)*				
Indicators	**Level of Aggreement**			
A. Physical Spaces	**4**	**3**	**2**	**1**
1. The classroom is secure and free from physical hazards.				
2. The policies on maintaining the physical safety within and outside the classroom for all students are implemented.				
3. The management and storage of documents are practiced properly with confidentiality by teachers and staff.				
4. The teachers and staff participate on tasks in security and monitoring that ensures the safety and security of students during and outside class hours.				
5. The students are aware of the different support services that help in ensuring their safety and needs.				
B. Social Spaces	**4**	**3**	**2**	**1**
1. The students are allowed to express their beliefs and identities without judgement.				
2. The students can actively seek help and ask for peer support in class.				
3. The institution maintains a positive vibe in making the students feel welcomed and respected.				
4. The institution implements policies on maintaining psychological safety within the school. (e.g. zero tolerance of harassment/bullying).				
5. The teachers and staff encourage students to interact with one another in positive ways.				
C. Institutions Implementation of R.A. 11313	**4**	**3**	**2**	**1**

1.	The institution has integrated the Safe Spaces Act during orientation programs to educate students about their rights and responsibilities under this law.				
2.	The institution has included information about the Safe Spaces Act in its student manual or handbook, ensuring that all students have access to clear guidelines and policies.				
3.	The institution actively promotes the Safe Spaces Act through posters, announcements, or online platforms to ensure widespread awareness within the campus community.				
4.	The academic departments include topics related to the Safe Spaces Act and its importance in relevant subjects or classroom discussions.				
5.	The Guidance Office provides counseling and support services for students who experience or witness violations of the Safe Spaces Act.				

PART III. LEVEL OF ADHERENCE TO THE SAFE SPACES ACT (R.A. 11313)

Direction: Please indicate the extent of your agreement as a BiPSU student regarding ***"R.A. 11313 – SAFE SPACES ACT"*** in terms of your **Level of Adherence** of the law within the school and university.

Please put a check on the appropriate answer using the following scale:

4 – Strongly Agree **3** – Agree **2** – *Disagree* **1** – Strongly Disagree

Level of Adherence to the Safe Spaces Act (R.A. 11313) *(Borito & Yango, 2022; Cruz et al., 2025)*					
Indicators		**Level of Aggreement**			
	A. Practices	**4**	**3**	**2**	**1**
1.	I actively avoid catcalling or making unsolicited comments about someone's appearance.				
2.	I refrain from making misogynistic, transphobic, homophobic, or sexist slurs in any setting.				
3.	I do not make or share sexual jokes or content that could make others uncomfortable.				
4.	I ensure that my online behavior does not include cyberbullying, cyberstalking, or gender-based online sexual harassment.				
5.	I avoid behaviors like wolf-whistling, making unwanted invitations, or engaging in groping or sexual assault.				
6.	I consciously avoid making offensive body gestures or engaging in actions that could be considered sexually inappropriate				
7.	I respect personal boundaries and avoid cursing, taunting, or using intrusive gazing toward others.				
8.	I report incidents of gender-based harassment or discrimination to the appropriate authorities if I witness or experience them.				
9.	I actively call out or discourage peers from making derogatory remarks or engaging in inappropriate actions against others.				
10.	I believe that my school is fostering a safe and inclusive environment and is shared responsibility among all students.				

Appendix E

Photos of the Site (Documentation)

Appendix F

Other Supporting Documents